TOPIC 03 · USE COPILOT TO CREATE DASHBOARDS

Lab 5 — Build a Recruitment KPI Dashboard with Copilot

Maps to	LO3: define recruitment KPIs, use Copilot Plan and Allow editing modes to build a dashboard of KPI cards, PivotTables, charts and slicers, and verify every KPI against an independent check
Duration	45 minutes
Tools	Excel · Copilot (Plan, Allow editing) · PivotTables, PivotCharts, slicers · BrightPath_Recruitment_Dashboard_Data.xlsx
Mock data	data/BrightPath_Recruitment_Dashboard_Data.xlsx
Course	Microsoft 365 Copilot for Excel (C34) · v2.0

Goal

Deliver a one-page H1 2026 recruitment dashboard whose five KPI cards, three charts and two slicers all agree with independently calculated checks.

What You Will Do

BrightPath's Head of Recruitment wants one page that shows H1 2026 applications, hires, offer acceptance rate, time to hire and cost per hire, by month, sector, source and recruiter. You will write the checks first, ask Copilot to plan the dashboard, review the plan against the KPI definitions, let Copilot build it in Allow editing mode, and then prove each KPI and slicer works.

What You Will Build

BrightPath_Recruitment_Dashboard_Data.xlsx with a Checks sheet and a Dashboard sheet holding five formula-driven KPI cards, charts for hires vs target by month, hires by sector and applications by source, and Sector and Recruiter slicers connected to every PivotTable

Prerequisites

- Topic 2 completed: you can build and verify PivotTables and charts with Copilot.
- This lab folder's data/BrightPath_Recruitment_Dashboard_Data.xlsx.

Data note

Use only the supplied fictional BrightPath data or information you are authorised to process. Do not paste credentials, confidential business material or real employees' personal data into Copilot.

Steps

Step 1. Go to onedrive.com (or your SharePoint site), open or create the folder work-c34 and select Upload > Files. Upload BrightPath_Recruitment_Dashboard_Data.xlsx from this lab's data folder, then open it in Excel for the web or select Open in Desktop App. Confirm the title bar shows the cloud location and AutoSave is On, and that Formulas > Calculation Options is set to Automatic. Read the About_This_Data sheet before you prompt. Read the KPI definitions row on About_This_Data carefully - the dashboard must follow them exactly.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Tables : tblApps (600 applications, Jan-Jun 2026) | tblTargets (monthly hire targets)
KPI definitions:
  Applications = number of rows
  Hires = Furthest_Stage = "Hired"
  Offer acceptance rate = accepted / (accepted + declined) (Pending excluded)
  Avg time to hire = average Time_to_Hire_Days of hires
  Cost per hire = total Sourcing_Cost / hires
```

Step 2. Before Copilot builds anything, create a sheet named Checks and type these independent KPI formulas yourself. These are the numbers the dashboard must match.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
A1 Applications B1 =ROWS(tblApps[Application_ID])
A2 Hires B2 =COUNTIFS(tblApps[Furthest_Stage],"Hired")
A3 Offer acceptance B3 =COUNTIFS(tblApps[Offer_Accepted],"Yes")/(COUNTIFS(tblApps[Offer_Accep
ted],"Yes")+COUNTIFS(tblApps[Offer_Accepted],"No"))
A4 Avg time to hire B4 =AVERAGEIFS(tblApps[Time_to_Hire_Days],tblApps[Furthest_Stage],"Hired")
A5 Cost per hire B5 =SUM(tblApps[Sourcing_Cost])/B2
```

Step 3. Choose Plan. Paste the dashboard brief below. Read Copilot's plan: does it use the same KPI definitions (especially excluding Pending offers) and count hires by Hire_Date month? Reply with corrections until the plan matches. Do not approve yet.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
GOAL: Build a one-page H1 2026 recruitment KPI dashboard on the Dashboard sheet.
CONTEXT: For BrightPath's Head of Recruitment; monthly review meeting.
DATA: tblApps and tblTargets only. Use the KPI definitions on About_This_Data.
CONSTRAINTS: Do not change tblApps or tblTargets. KPI cards must be formulas, not typed
numbers.
OUTPUT:
  Row 1: title "Recruitment Dashboard - Jan to Jun 2026" and "Data as at 2026-06-30".
  Row 3: five KPI cards - Applications, Hires, Offer acceptance rate, Avg time to hire (days),
         Cost per hire (S$).
  Below: (1) column chart of hires by Hire_Date month with a line for Hire_Target from
tblTargets,
         (2) bar chart of hires by Sector sorted highest first,
         (3) bar chart of applications by Source.
  Slicers for Sector and Recruiter connected to all PivotTables. Put PivotTables on a sheet
Dash_Data.
REVIEW: List each KPI formula you will use before building.
```

Step 4. When the plan is right, switch to Allow editing and tell Copilot to carry it out. Watch the steps in the pane; you can select Stop if it goes off track. When it finishes, open Dash_Data and the Dashboard and review what was created.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
The plan is approved. Build the dashboard exactly as planned.
```

Step 5. Compare each KPI card with Checks!B1:B5 (with no slicer selected). Click each card to see its formula. Fix any difference with a targeted follow-up prompt - the most common error is including Pending offers.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
FOLLOW-UP EXAMPLE:
The Offer acceptance rate card must exclude Offer_Accepted = "Pending". Change its formula to
accepted / (accepted + declined) and show it as a percentage with 1 decimal.
```

Step 6. Test interactivity. Select Technology on the Sector slicer and check that every chart and KPI card changes. Compare with COUNTIFS for Technology. Then clear the slicer.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
CHECK (Technology):
=COUNTIFS(tblApps[Sector],"Technology")
=COUNTIFS(tblApps[Sector],"Technology",tblApps[Furthest_Stage],"Hired")

If a KPI card does not change, ask: "Make the KPI cards respond to the Sector and Recruiter
slicers."
```

Step 7. Polish with one prompt per change, then ask Copilot (Chat only) to review the dashboard for clarity. Log all prompts on Prompt_Log.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Add a note under the title: "Source: tblApps; KPI definitions on About_This_Data".
Use one consistent colour scheme and align the charts in a grid.
CHAT ONLY: Review this dashboard for a Head of Recruitment. What is unclear or missing?
```

Sample Prompts

Use these prompts in the Copilot pane (or adapt them). Name the table and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. The same prompts are in sample-prompts.txt in this lab folder.

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Plan	Plan a recruitment KPI dashboard on the Dashboard sheet from tblApps with KPI cards for applications, hires, offer acceptance rate, average time to hire and cost per hire. List the formulas before building.
2	KPI card	Create a KPI card that shows Cost per hire = total Sourcing_Cost / hires, formatted as S$ with 2 decimals.
3	Chart vs target	Create a column chart of hires by Hire_Date month with Hire_Target from tblTargets as a line.
4	Slicers	Add slicers for Sector and Recruiter and connect them to all PivotTables on Dash_Data.
5	Fix a KPI	The offer acceptance rate must exclude Pending offers. Update the formula and explain it.
6	Layout	Arrange the KPI cards in one row and the three charts in a grid below them with equal sizes.
7	Review	Review this dashboard for a Head of Recruitment. What is unclear, missing or potentially misleading?
8	Question	Which recruiter made the most hires in H1 2026, and what was their average time to hire?

Test It

Expected results

With no slicer selected the KPI cards match Checks: Applications 600, Hires 41, Offer acceptance 78.8% (41 accepted of 52 decided; 10 pending excluded), Avg time to hire 27.8 days, Cost per hire S$348.20. Hires by month: 2026-02 = 9, 2026-03 = 10, 2026-04 = 9, 2026-05 = 7, 2026-06 = 6 (none in 2026-01). Manufacturing has the most hires (11). With Sector = Technology, Applications = 124, Hires = 5 and Avg time to hire = 42.0 days. Siti Hamid made the most hires (13). No KPI card contains a typed number.

Checkpoint

Keep the workbook in work-c34. Lab 6 builds a second dashboard from the workforce workbook in its own folder.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot builds before you approve the plan.	You were in Allow editing mode. Undo (Ctrl+Z) or restore from version history, switch to Plan and resubmit.
KPI cards do not change when a slicer is used.	Cards built with COUNTIFS on tblApps ignore slicers. Ask Copilot to base them on the PivotTables (GETPIVOTDATA) or accept that cards show the H1 total and label them so.
Hires appear in January.	The chart is counting by Applied_Month. Ask Copilot to group hires by Hire_Date month as the KPI definition says.
Copilot stops part-way or times out.	Ask it to continue from the last completed step, or split the build into KPI cards, then charts, then slicers.

Challenge

Ask Copilot to add a sixth KPI card for 'Hires vs target %' (hires / sum of targets) and conditional formatting that turns it red below 90%. Verify it with your own formula.

Reflection

Which KPI definition was easiest to get subtly wrong, and how would you stop that happening next month?